

ChatGPT ▾

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I think it would be valuable to have planning documentation for future versions of the app in the project. Can you do a first pass on writing that?

Yes. In fact, I think this is one of the few places where AI-generated planning documents add real value to a portfolio project.

For NextSeason, I'd keep future planning separate from the MVP requirements so that:

- MVP scope remains protected.
- Future ideas are documented and don't get lost.
- You can demonstrate product thinking beyond the initial release.

I'd suggest a file called **PostMVPRoadmap.md**.

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NextSeason - Post MVP Roadmap

Purpose

This document captures potential enhancements for future versions of NextSeason after MVP release.

Items in this document are intentionally out of scope for MVP.

Inclusion here does not imply commitment to implementation. Features should be re-evaluated based on user feedback, technical complexity, and business goals.

Guiding Principles

Future development should prioritize:

1. Increasing user value.
2. Improving notification accuracy.
3. Reducing user effort.
4. Maintaining a simple, approachable experience.
5. Avoiding feature bloat.

The application should remain focused on helping users know when new seasons of shows become available.

Version 1.1 - Quality Improvements

Better Show Discovery

Motivation

Users may struggle to locate shows with common or ambiguous titles.

Potential Enhancements

- Improved search ranking.
- Display show posters in search results.
- Display release year.
- Display network or streaming service.
- Show genre tags.

Priority

High

Watchlist Organization

Motivation

As watchlists grow, users need better ways to manage them.

Potential Enhancements

- Sort by title.
- Sort by next release date.
- Sort by recently updated.
- Filter watched/unwatched.
- Hide ended shows.

Priority

High

Richer Show Details

Motivation

Users may want additional context before adding a show.

Potential Enhancements

- Show poster artwork.
- Show summary.
- Cast information.
- Episode counts.

- Season history.

Priority

Medium

Version 1.2 - Notifications

Local Notifications

Motivation

Users should not need to manually open the app to discover updates.

Potential Enhancements

- Local notifications when a tracked show receives a newly announced season.
- Notification settings per show.
- Notification history screen.

Technical Notes

Would require background refresh and notification permissions.

Priority

High

Release Date Notifications

Motivation

Announcement of a season and availability of a season are separate events.

Potential Enhancements

Notify users when:

- A season is announced.
- A release date is announced.
- The season becomes available.

Priority

High

Version 2.0 - Accounts and Sync

User Accounts

Motivation

Allow users to retain watchlists across devices.

Potential Enhancements

- Sign in with Apple.
- Secure cloud storage.
- Multi-device synchronization.

Technical Notes

This represents a major architectural change and should only be pursued after validating product-market fit.

Priority

Medium

Cloud Backup

Motivation

Protect user data from device loss.

Potential Enhancements

- Automatic backup.
- Restore from backup.
- Device migration support.

Priority

Medium

Version 2.1 - Streaming Availability

Streaming Service Tracking

Motivation

Users care not only that a season exists, but where it can be watched.

Potential Enhancements

Display availability on services such as:

- Netflix
- Hulu
- Max
- Disney+

- Apple TV+
- Prime Video

Challenges

Requires a reliable streaming availability data source.

Priority

High

Preferred Services

Motivation

Users may subscribe to only a subset of streaming services.

Potential Enhancements

- Select owned services.
- Prioritize relevant notifications.
- Hide unavailable content.

Priority

High

Version 3.0 - Advanced Tracking

Follow Actors

Motivation

Users often discover shows through favorite actors.

Potential Enhancements

- Track actors.
- Notify when actors appear in new series.
- Recommend related content.

Priority

Low

Follow Networks

Motivation

Some users primarily follow content from specific providers.

Potential Enhancements

- Follow streaming services.
- Follow television networks.
- Receive announcements for new series.

Priority

Low

Recommendations

Motivation

Help users discover additional content.

Potential Enhancements

- Similar shows.
- Genre-based recommendations.
- Recommendations based on watchlist.

Priority

Low

Business and Monetization Ideas

These items should only be considered after validating that users find the application useful.

Optional Premium Tier

Potential features:

- Unlimited watchlist size.
- Advanced notifications.
- Streaming availability tracking.
- Cross-device synchronization.

One-Time Purchase

Alternative approach:

- Free trial.
- Single unlock purchase.
- No subscription requirement.

Affiliate Revenue

Potential future revenue source:

- Deep links to streaming services.
- Affiliate relationships where available.

Metrics to Evaluate After MVP

Before implementing major features, gather data on:

- Daily active users.
- Watchlist size distribution.
- Most searched shows.
- Notification engagement.
- User retention.

Future priorities should be driven by actual user behavior whenever possible.

Explicit Non-Goals

The following are not currently aligned with the product vision:

- Social networking features.
- User-generated reviews.
- Episode-by-episode tracking.
- Discussion forums.
- Complex recommendation engines.
- General-purpose TV database functionality.

NextSeason should remain focused on helping users know when new seasons of shows become available.

A few notes after reviewing the current state of the project:

1. **Streaming availability** is the biggest feature that would make the app genuinely useful in real life. "Season 4 is available" is much more valuable if it immediately says *"on Hulu"*.
2. **Local notifications** are the first feature I'd build after MVP. Without notifications, users have to remember to open the app.
3. I would continue to **defer accounts/login** until you have evidence people want the app. Local-only is still the correct MVP decision.
4. I'd explicitly keep recommendations, social features, ratings, reviews, and similar "TV app" ideas out of the roadmap for now. They add a huge amount of complexity without strengthening the core value proposition.

If you like this direction, I'd also create a companion **ArchitectureEvolution.md** document describing how

the current MVP architecture would need to change to support notifications, accounts, syncing, and streaming-provider data. That document is often extremely useful when using AI coding tools because it gives them a long-term architectural target.

 Uploaded a file

There's the latest code. Please review completely, paying special attention to notifications as you described above.

 Uploaded a file

Ok, I've had cursor address your issues with notifications. How does it look?

I'll compare this snapshot against the notification concerns from the prior review and focus on whether the fixes are structurally sound rather than just present.

Thought for 34s >

It looks much better.

The notification fixes I specifically wanted are now present:

- Delegate installation moved into `NextSeasonApp.init()`
- Notification routing buffers a tapped show ID if the coordinator is not ready yet
- Pending notification navigation is resolved both on initial `.task` and on `pendingShowID` changes
- "Not Now" is now persisted with `notificationPromptDeferred`
- background refresh scheduling errors are logged in `DEBUG`
- background task expiration now calls `setTaskCompleted(success: false)`

One small caveat: the "Not Now" deferral is currently permanent. That's fine for MVP, but later you may want "ask again after X days" or a Settings toggle.

I'd classify notifications now as:

Implemented and structurally sound; needs real-device/TestFlight validation.

The remaining risks are mostly iOS behavior, not code structure:

- background refresh may not run when you expect
- notification tap routing should be tested from terminated app state
- permission prompt timing should be watched with beta users

I don't see an obvious remaining blocker in the notification implementation.

I did test it from terminated app state; it works.

That's actually the most important test.

A surprising number of notification implementations work perfectly when:

- app is running
- app is backgrounded

...and then fail when:

- app is terminated
- user taps notification
- app cold-launches

because the navigation stack isn't ready yet.

Since you've verified the terminated-state flow on a physical device, I'd consider the notification feature essentially complete for MVP purposes.

At this point I'd move notifications from my mental list of concerns into the "watch during beta" category and shift attention to things that are more likely to affect first impressions:

Highest priorities now

1. Search quality

- Fuzzy matching
- Better ranking
- Handling punctuation/articles
- Misspellings

2. UI polish

- Visual hierarchy
- Empty states
- Color palette
- General "does this feel finished?"

3. Discoverability

- Is it obvious how to track a show?
- Is it obvious when a show is already tracked?
- Is it obvious what changed?

4. Beta program

- Real-world data quality
- UX feedback
- Unexpected user behavior

One thing I noticed during these reviews is that the project has quietly crossed an important threshold.

A few versions ago I was mostly finding **missing systems**:

- notifications
- background refresh
- routing
- persistence concerns

Now most of my comments are about:

- UX
- product decisions
- beta testing
- polish

That's usually a sign that the architecture is stabilizing and you're entering the phase where real users become more valuable than additional engineering.

In other words, if I had to choose between:

- implementing Actor Tracking, or
- putting five non-technical people in front of the app,

I'd pick the five users without hesitation.

Those sessions will likely generate a month's worth of roadmap items.

And honestly, as someone who's reviewed every snapshot you've uploaded, that's a pretty good place for an MVP to be.

Please make two documents, based on what we've discussed here. One is for final tasks to be completed before the app is linked from my resume and distributed to friends for initial feedback (I guess we could call those the final MVP steps) and another for future work.

I think these should be two separate documents:

1. **ReleaseReadiness.md** — everything required before you put the app on your resume and hand it to friends/testers.
2. **PostMVPRoadmap.md** — future enhancements and product evolution.

The distinction is important because "before first users" and "future feature work" are very different priorities.

ReleaseReadiness.md

Edit



NextSeason - Release Readiness

Purpose

This document tracks the work required before NextSeason is shared publicly, linked from a resume, or distributed to beta testers.

The goal is not to add major new functionality. The goal is to ensure the application feels professional, understandable, and reliable.

Release Criteria

Before sharing the application with external users:

- Core functionality is complete.
- No known critical defects exist.
- Basic usability issues have been addressed.
- Application behavior is predictable.
- The app reflects professional software engineering practices.

High Priority

Search Quality Improvements

Goal

Users should be able to find the show they are looking for even when search terms are imperfect.

Potential Improvements

- Ignore punctuation differences.
- Ignore common articles ("The", "A").
- Improve result ranking.
- Handle common abbreviations.
- Handle partial title searches.
- Improve matching of alternate show names.

Success Criteria

Most users can successfully find and track a show without needing multiple search attempts.

Watchlist Discoverability

Goal

New users should immediately understand how to track a show.

Questions

- Is the Track button obvious?
- Is it clear when a show is already tracked?
- Is it obvious how to remove a show?
- Is it obvious what the app does?

Potential Improvements

- More prominent tracking controls.
 - Better visual feedback when tracking begins.
 - Empty-state guidance.
 - Improved onboarding copy.
-

Visual Polish

Goal

The application should feel intentional and complete.

Potential Improvements

- App-wide color palette.
- Consistent spacing.
- Improved typography hierarchy.
- Better loading states.

- Better empty states.
- Refined dark mode appearance.
- Final app icon.

Success Criteria

Users describe the app as "finished" rather than "a prototype."

Medium Priority

First-Run Experience

Goal

Help users understand the app without instructions.

Potential Improvements

- Welcome screen.
 - Brief explanation of purpose.
 - Suggested first search.
 - Guidance when watchlist is empty.
-

Accessibility Review

Verify

- Dynamic Type support.
 - VoiceOver navigation.
 - Button labeling.
 - Color contrast.
 - Focus order.
-

Analytics Foundation

Goal

Collect enough information to guide future product decisions.

Suggested Metrics

- Searches performed.
- Search result counts.
- Search-to-track conversion.
- Watchlist additions.
- Watchlist removals.
- Notification opens.

Feedback Mechanism

Goal

Make it easy for beta users to report issues.

Options

- Email feedback link.
 - Report incorrect data action.
 - Simple feedback form.
-

Beta Testing

Initial Test Group

Target 5-10 users.

Prefer:

- Non-technical users.
 - Frequent television viewers.
 - iPhone users of varying experience levels.
-

Validation Tasks

Ask testers to:

1. Search for a favorite show.
2. Add a show to the watchlist.
3. Remove a show from the watchlist.
4. Understand recent updates.
5. Enable notifications.

Observe without providing instructions.

Success Criteria

Users can complete common tasks without assistance.

Repeated confusion should generate roadmap items.

Technical Validation

Notifications

Verify:

- Permission request flow.
- Background delivery.
- Notification tap routing.
- Duplicate suppression.
- Cold-launch behavior.

Status: Implemented. Continue validation during beta.

Data Accuracy

Verify:

- Search results are relevant.
- Season information is accurate.
- Change detection behaves as expected.

Portfolio Readiness

Before linking from resume:

- README updated.
- Screenshots available.
- Architecture documented.
- AI-assisted development process documented.
- No known critical issues.

The application should demonstrate product thinking, engineering judgment, and effective AI collaboration.

PostMVPRoadmap.md

 Edit



NextSeason - Post MVP Roadmap

Purpose

This document captures potential future enhancements after the initial beta release.

Items here are intentionally lower priority than release readiness work.

Future priorities should be informed by user behavior, beta feedback, and analytics.

Core Product Improvements

Search Enhancements

Motivation

Search quality is critical to the application's success.

Potential Features

- Fuzzy matching.
- Typo tolerance.
- Search suggestions.
- Recent searches.
- Alternate title support.
- Improved ranking.

Priority: High

Watchlist Management

Potential Features

- Sorting options.
- Filtering options.
- Grouping options.
- Hide ended shows.

Priority: High

Notification Enhancements

Potential Features

- Notification settings.
- Per-show notification preferences.
- Quiet hours.
- Notification history.
- Different notification types.

Examples:

- Season announced.
- Release date announced.
- Season available.

Priority: High

Streaming Availability

Streaming Provider Information

Motivation

Knowing where a season is available is often more valuable than knowing that it exists.

Potential Features

Display availability on:

- Netflix
- Hulu
- Disney+
- Max
- Apple TV+
- Prime Video

Priority: High

Preferred Services

Potential Features

- Track subscribed services.
- Filter unavailable content.
- Prioritize relevant notifications.

Priority: High

Product Intelligence

Recommendations

Potential Features

- Similar shows.
- Genre recommendations.
- Watchlist-based suggestions.

Priority: Medium

Actor Tracking

Potential Features

- Follow actors.
- Actor-based discovery.
- Notifications for new projects.

Priority: Medium

Network and Studio Tracking

Potential Features

- Follow networks.
- Follow streaming providers.
- New series announcements.

Priority: Medium

Platform Features

User Accounts

Motivation

Allow synchronization across devices.

Potential Features

- Sign in with Apple.
- Cloud sync.
- Cross-device watchlists.

Priority: Medium

Cloud Backup

Potential Features

- Backup and restore.
- Device migration support.

Priority: Medium

Product Analytics

Future Investigation

Use analytics and feedback to answer questions such as:

- What are users searching for?
- What shows are most tracked?
- Which notifications are most useful?
- Which features are requested most often?

Future development should be driven by observed user behavior whenever possible.

Business Options

Evaluate only after validating user demand.

Possible Models

- One-time purchase.
- Premium upgrade.
- Subscription.
- Affiliate revenue.

No monetization strategy should compromise the simplicity of the product.

Explicit Non-Goals

The following are not currently aligned with the product vision:

- Social networking.
- User reviews.
- Episode tracking.
- Discussion forums.
- Complex media database features.

NextSeason should remain focused on helping users know when new seasons of shows become available.

One thing I intentionally changed from my earlier roadmap: **Search Improvements appear in both documents.**

Normally I'd avoid duplication, but in this case search is both:

- a release-readiness concern (it needs to be good enough before users see it), and
- a long-term product area that can continue improving for years.

That feels true to where the project is today. The app no longer needs major systems built; it mostly needs to become easier, prettier, and more forgiving for real people.

